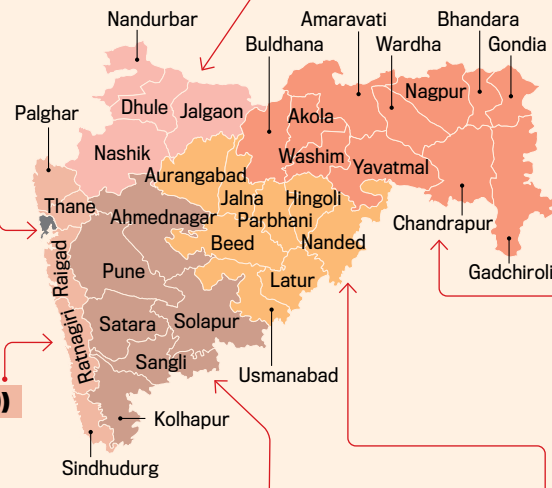
REGIONAL ISSUES

MUMBAI (36)

- Lack of affordable housing pushes middle classes beyond city fringes
- Delays in slum redevelopment projects. Anger among slum dwellers in Dharavi
- Poor state of the public transport infrastructure, including the BEST buses

THANE & THE KONKAN (39)

- Anger over projects like the Vadhavan port, Virar-Alibag multimodal corridor and the petrochemical refinery at Barsu, which locals fear may affect the environment and their livelihoods
- Unemployment and migration of youth from Raigad etc.
- Mango growers upset at crop losses, lack of mitigation measures
- Anger in numerically-significant groups like the Kunbis over the demand by Marathas for inclusion in the OBC category



NORTH MAHARASHTRA (47)

- No compensation for those affected by '*ola dushkaal* (excess rains)'
- Anger among tribals over Dhangar quota demand and recruitment of non-tribals in PESA areas
- Poor social infrastructure in tribal pockets like Nandurbar
- Onion farmers miffed at central policies

VIDARBHA (62)

- Cotton/soyabean growers angry at lack of remunerative pricing
- Man-animal conflict in tiger- and leopard-bearing areas
- Industrial development concentrated in urban centres like Nagpur
- No jobs for the youth

WEST MAHARASHTRA (58)

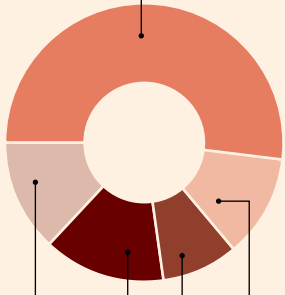
- No jobs; mega projects being diverted from Maharashtra to Gujarat
- Agniveer scheme makes defence forces career less lucrative for youth
- Demand for Maratha and Dhangar quotas
- Lack of irrigation schemes and potable water in rainshadow areas

MARATHWADA (46)

- Demand for Maratha quotas and the Maratha vs OBC cleavage
- Anger against BJP and Fadnavis
- Agrarian distress and unrest among soyabean farmers over low market prices for their produce
- Lack of development, industrialisation and jobs

CASTE BREAK-UP

OBCs
52%
(This includes the Kunbis, who are considered part of the Maratha-Kunbi caste complex and also 8.4% non-Hindu OBCs)



Open category
10-14%
(This includes around 100 castes)

STs
9%

SCs
12%

Marathas
12-16%

SWOT ANALYSIS

MAHAYUTI

STRENGTHS

- Ability to deploy resources, micro-manage campaigns
- Leaders with firm sub-regional base
- Welfare cash transfer schemes like Ladki Bahin

WEAKNESSES

- Anti-incumbency
- Poor morale after the LS drubbing
- Anger among Marathas, Dalits, tribals, Dhangars, and farmers

OPPORTUNITIES

- Create caste-neutral constituencies among women and the aged using welfare schemes
- Growing cosmopolitanism which boosts base of parties like BJP
- Original Shiv Sena name, bow-and-arrow symbol with CM Eknath Shinde faction

THREATS

- Perception that mega projects went to Gujarat when joblessness is rising in Maharashtra
- Perceived sympathy for Pawar Sr and Uddhav Thackeray after their parties break up
- BJP-NCP alliance upset core voters

MAHA VIKAS AGHADI

STRENGTHS

- Anger at Mahayuti among Marathas, Dalits, tribals, OBCs, Muslims
- Creation of a rainbow coalition
- LS performance: won 31 of 48 seats

WEAKNESSES

- Overconfidence after LS verdict
- Congress factionalism; Shiv Sena (UBT), Congress sniping at each other

OPPORTUNITIES

- Middle class peeved at Mahayuti's 'revdi' culture
- Rise of a new leadership in Sena (UBT) and NCP (SCP) after splits in both parties

THREATS

- Section of the Shiv Sena's core voters gravitating towards BJP and Shinde Sena
- Balancing interests of disparate constituents of MVA's rainbow coalition
- Possibility of local rebellions due to a large number of ticket aspirants; smaller parties taking Muslim, Maratha votes in multi-cornered fights